



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's fun to catch up with a colleague!



Learning Outcome

Describe past experiences in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have a coffee break during your workday or school day? When is it?
- What do you chat with your friends about?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can talk about people's past habits.





Let's Explore!

Peter chats with a colleague over **coffee break***.

* A "coffee break" in many North American workplaces is usually 15 minutes twice a day.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Brad:** Hey, Peter. How are things?
Peter: Not too bad, Brad. Want a coffee?
Brad: Sure. It's nice to have a break in the middle of the morning.
Peter: Yeah, I used to make myself a cappuccino every morning, but these days I don't give myself enough time.
Brad: I used to consume 6 cups of coffee during the workday. I've tried to cut down. Have a seat. So how's your job been?
Peter: Pretty good. I've worked on a marketing strategy all morning. I haven't done this type of project before, so there is a bit of a learning curve.
Brad: Oh, I used to write marketing plans, so I could help you. I would survey the market for that product. I would find out the sales goals, and then I would come up with a strategy. Consumers generally responded well.
Peter: Right on! The promotions I consulted on before weren't quite the same, but I've learned a lot from my colleagues here.
Brad: Excellent! Well, I've had enough caffeine for the morning.





Let's Practice!

Peter discusses his job with Brad. What do they say?

Instructions: Read the dialogue on page 2 again. Select the correct answer for the following questions.

1. When are Peter and Brad having coffee?
 - a) First thing in the morning
 - b) In the middle of the morning
 - c) At lunch time
2. Has Peter written a marketing strategy before?
 - a) He has done many before.
 - b) He has never done it before.
 - c) He has done only one before.
3. How did consumers respond to Brad's marketing plans before?
 - a) Consumers responded well.
 - b) Consumers find out the sales goals.
 - c) Consumers came up with a strategy.



Let's Practice!

Has Peter had experience in this job?

Instructions: Choose the correct word in bold to correctly complete the sentence.

1. I've **tried** / **try** to cut down on the number of cups of coffee.
2. How has your job **bin** / **been**, Peter?
3. I haven't **dune** / **done** this type of project before.
4. I've **turned** / **learned** a lot from my colleagues here.
5. I've **working** / **worked** on a marketing strategy.
6. I've **had** / **have** enough work for today.





Extension Activity

Compare new experiences with your partner.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write down 3 new things you have experienced in the last 2 years.
- Write down 3 things you have stopped doing in the last 2 years.
- Use Present Perfect tense in your sentences.
- Read your 6 sentences to your partner. Ask them about their experiences.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write complete statements on new experiences.

☐ ☐

I name some habits I have stopped.

☐ ☐

I exchange ideas about experiences with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **break** (noun): a short time of rest to break up the workday
e.g. The workers took a short coffee break.
- **workday** (noun): a day on which you work at a job
e.g. He would write marketing plans on a typical workday.
- **to have a seat** (verb): to take a rest sitting down
e.g. She asked her friend to have a seat during their coffee break.
- **to survey** (verb): to check out an area in search of something
e.g. Shoppers would survey the market for a certain product.
- **to come up with** (verb): to discover the answer to something
e.g. He would always come up with a strategy.
- **to find out** (verb): to know for the first time; to realize
e.g. He wanted to find out the sales goals for his co-worker.



Learning Points

Present Perfect and Past Simple Tenses

You use the **Present Perfect** tense to talk about an action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the **Simple Past** tense to talk about a finished action or event not connected to the present.

When you use the **Present Perfect** tense, there is a connection between what happened in the past and now. You can use time markers like *for*, *just* and *ever*.

When you use the **Simple Past** tense, the time is always in the past. You can use time markers like: *then*, *ago*, *yesterday*, *when I was ...*

Look at the chart to see how to form the **Present Perfect** tense:

Base form	Past tense form	Present Perfect form	Example
try	tried	has/have tried	<i>I have tried to cut down on the amount of coffee I drink.</i>
do	did	has/have done	<i>I haven't done this type of project before.</i>
be	was	has/have been	<i>How has your job been?</i>
learn	learned	has/have learned	<i>I have learned a lot from my colleagues here.</i>





Learning Points

Habits of the Past

Used to and *would* express a pattern of action that occurred regularly in the past.

Both *used to* and *would* are followed by the base form of the verb.

Subject + *used to* + verb

I used to take a walk everyday.

Subject + *would* + verb

I would walk 3 miles every evening.

Used to	Would
<i>I used to make myself a cappuccino every morning.</i>	<i>I would get up a little earlier to heat up the machine.</i>
<i>I used to have 6 cups of coffee during the workday.</i>	<i>Every hour I would go back for another cup.</i>
<i>I used to write marketing plans.</i>	<i>I would survey the market for that product. I would find out the sales goals. I would come up with a strategy.</i>

